Citation of Sources

H 203

A. Background 1
B. Recent revisions 2
C. General rules for citing sources 2
C.1. Subfield $w in the work cat. citation 2
C.2. Data found 3
D. Citing publications 3
D.1. When to omit volume and page numbers 3
D.2. When to include volume and page numbers 4
D.3. Citing serial publications 4
D.4. Citing web sites 5
D.5. Citing web-based video and audio sources 5
E. Citing sources that are not publications 6
E.1. U.S. Board on Geographic Names (BGN) 6
E.2. Citing the Library of Congress database 6
E.3. Citing telephone calls and email correspondence 6
E.4. Citing the Old Catalog heading 7
F. Citing sources in which the heading was not found 7
Revision history 7

A. Background

Subject authority records include 670 (Sources found) and 675 (Sources not found) fields. Because these records are distributed to bibliographic utilities and other subscribers, the sources in these fields should be cited in a style that is brief, but clear and understandable to users of the authority records. This instruction sheet describes a suggested method of citing sources. However, as long as the appropriate data elements are present, the exact style of the citation is left to cataloger's judgment.

B. Recent revisions

2026-03: Updated template. Corrected faulty metadata. Reorganized and updated text and added examples.

C. General rules for citing sources

Provide the primary contributor (when applicable), title, and date of publication in subfield $a. Provide the data found in that source in subfield $b. The following format and punctuation style are suggested:

Example:

```
670 ## $a [author]. [title], [date of publication]: $b [volume, page, etc.]
      ([data found])
```

C.1. Subfield $w in the work cat. citation

When citing the work being cataloged (work cat.), include a $w subfield containing the work cat.'s bibliographic control number or identifier.

C.1.a. LC catalogers and CIP partners

In the $w field, LC catalogers should give the LCCN of the work, if the work being is being cataloged at the Library of Congress or is a CIP that is being cataloged as part of the CIP Partnership Program. Input DLC enclosed in parentheses at the beginning of the subfield and then input the LCCN. Do not leave a space between the closing parenthesis and the number.

Example:

```
$w (DLC)2019300716
```

C.1.b. SACO catalogers

SACO libraries may input either their local bibliographic record control number or the bibliographic record control number from a bibliographic utility (e.g., an OCLC number), but not an LCCN, into the $w subfield if the work being cataloged is not an LC CIP. Precede the control number by the MARC organization code for the agency to which the number applies, enclosed in parentheses. Do not leave a space between the closing parenthesis and the number.

Example:

```
$w (OCoLC)198765401
```

Note: Provide only one $w subfield per 670 field. The subfield is repeatable, but it is not repeated in LCSH authority records.

C.2. Data found

Provide the terminology and any variant terms, and definitions or descriptions found in the cited source. Put this information in parentheses following the citation in a $b subfield. Use punctuation as needed to separate pieces of data. If information is quoted from the source exactly, place it in quotation marks.

Examples:

```
Heading proposed: Draco (Constellation)

670 ## $a Astronomy encyclopedia, 2002 $b (Draco; eighth-largest constellation,
       representing the dragon Ladon in Greek mythology; lies between Ursa Major
       and Cepheus, near the north celestial pole, and surrounds Ursa Minor on
       three sides)


Heading proposed: Bandolin

670 ## $a Garland encyclopedia of world music: $b v. 2, p. 417 ((Ecuador): The
       bandolín is a type of flat-backed mandolin with five courses of triple
       strings struck with a plectrum. It is played by Quichua and Iberian-
       Ecuadorians in the highlands; certain Imbabura villages, such as Ilumán,
       used to be famous for their proliferation of bandolines)
```

D. Citing publications

D.1. When to omit volume and page numbers

As a general rule, omit the volume and page number where information relevant to the proposal was found, if (a) the source being cited is alphabetically arranged, and (b) the heading being proposed, or a reference to it, is found in its normal alphabetical location in the source.

Examples:

- If a heading for the Battle of Chemulpo is proposed and *The Dictionary of Battles and Sieges* is cited as a source, the volume and page number in the dictionary may be omitted since the dictionary is an alphabetically arranged list of battles and the entry for Chemulpo is found under the letter "**C**".
- If ***Empire State Building (New York, N.Y.)*** is proposed, and *Americana* is cited as a source, the volume and page number may be omitted, since an article on the building appears directly under the letter "**E**" in the encyclopedia.

Also omit volume and page numbers when citing as a source a publication that has the proposed heading within its title.

Example:

If the heading *__Privatization__* is proposed, no page number is required when citing the following as a source: Goldman, H. The privatization book, 1984.

Note: When citing a work such as this in order to justify variant forms that are found in the text and that have been provided as UFs, or to provide other information about the term, cite the page number(s) where the variants and/or information is found.

D.2. When to include volume and page numbers

As a general rule, include the volume and page number where relevant information was found if either (a) the source is not an alphabetically arranged work, and it is necessary to browse or use the table of contents and/or index to locate information that supports the proposal or (b) the source is alphabetically arranged, but the information that supports the proposal being made appears in a place other than the alphabetical position of the proposed heading.

Example:

If the heading *__Coit Memorial Tower (San Francisco, Calif.)__* is proposed and *Americana* is cited as a source, the volume and page number are required because this term appears only in the article about San Francisco, and there is no entry or reference to it under the letter *__C__*.

When including a volume and/or page number, place them following the source citation in a $b subfield.

Example:

```
670 ## $a Americana: $b v. 24, p. 199 (in article on San Francisco: Coit Tower;
       rises 210 feet (64 meters) atop Telegraph Hill)
```

D.3. Citing serial publications

When citing any serial as a source, provide the volume number (or date) of the issue(s) consulted, in addition to the other information specified above.

Examples:

```
670 ## $a Biol. & agr. index: $b v. 38 ([data found])

670 ## $a Southwestern naturalist, via JSTOR, viewed Aug. 16, 2007: $b v. 9,
       no. 2, 1964 ([data found])

670 ## $a NYT index, 1984 $b ([data found])

670 ## $a Journal of colloid and interface science, viewed Aug 23, 2021: $b v.
       521 (July 2018), p. 69 ([data found])
```

```
670 ## $a Pharmaceutical trends, Jan. 1978: $b p. 2 ([data found])
```

D.4. Citing web sites

Give the name of the web site and the date it was consulted. In subfield $b, give a location, if appropriate, and the information found. Include the date viewed in the $a subfield.

Example:

Heading proposed: DataTimes (Information retrieval system)

```
670 ## $a DataTimes web site, viewed May 16, 1996: $b main menu (DataTimes
       information network)
```

Names of search engines should be cited only when it is useful to provide hit counts for variant terminology.

Example:

Heading proposed: Benghazi Consulate Attack, Banghāzī, Libya, 2012

```
670 ## $a Google, Jan. 25, 2013 $b (hit counts: US Consulate attack, 2,610,000;
       Benghazi Consulate attack, 1,580,000; US Mission attack, 190,000;
       Benghazi Mission attack, 274,000)
```

Note: Catalogers are strongly discouraged from providing a URI (Uniform Resource Identifier) in the 670 field, since URIs are unstable and addresses often change. However, when the work being cataloged is a digital resource, provide a URI if possible. Prefer a persistent URI over a URI produced via search. If there is no persistent URI, do not create one. In the situations where it is necessary to cite a URI, the 670 $u subfield must be used for this purpose.

Example:

```
670 $a Charles H. Bronson Commissioner of Agriculture, Florida Department of
       Agriculture and Consumer Services, Technical Bulletin Number 3, August 9,
       2002, viewed online August 30, 2019: $b page 2 (Apple snails belong to
       the phylum Mollusca, class Gastropoda (snails), subclass Prosobranchia,
       order Mesogastropoda, family Ampullariidae (apple snails).) $u
       http://edocs.dlis.state.fl.us/fldocs/doacs/aquaculture/techbull/2002no3.p
       df
```

D.5. Citing web-based video and audio sources

In the $a subfield, provide the name of the resource, the platform or service used to access it, and the date it was consulted. Include the information and its location in the resource in the $b subfield.

Example:

```
670 ## $a Useful Charts channel, via YouTube, viewed July 29, 2022: $b Writing
       systems of the World (abjads, alphabets, abugidas, syllabaries,
       logosyllabaries) $u https://youtu.be/Mmz42awTRsA?si=R8vRbK11vIR91mDE
```

E. Citing sources that are not publications

E.1. U.S. Board on Geographic Names (BGN)

In most cases, information is obtained from BGN via the Internet, using the Geographic Names Information System (GNIS) or the Geographic Names Server (GNS) (cf. H 690, D. Form of heading). Cite these sources in the following manner:

```
670 ## $a GNIS [or GNS], [date searched]: $b ([approved form, location and type
       of feature, coordinates]; variants: [variants provided])
```

See also the instructions in DCM Z1—670 Source Data Found—Special types of citations—U.S. Board on Geographic Names (BGN) to see all the options for how to record the information for geographic features.

Examples:

```
670 ## $a GEOnet, July 29, 2015: $b (Tokaji Hegy, mountain in Borsod-Abaúj-
       Zemplén, Hungary; 48°07′00″N 021°23′00″E; variants: Kopasz, Tokaj Hegy,
       Kopasz, Hegy, Nagy-Kopasz, Tokaj, Tokaj Hegy)

670 ## $a GNIS, Feb. 10, 2023: $b (Chimney Rock Bluff; cliff; Newton County,
       Arkansas; 36.0078540, -93.0804523)
```

E.2. Citing the Library of Congress database

Use the phrase ***LC database*** as a standard way of indicating that the term being proposed as a heading or reference was found in titles in bibliographic records in the LC Database. Use ***LC name authority file*** to cite the Library of Congress name authority file (LC/NAF).

Example:

```
Heading proposed: Environmental auditing

670 ## $a LC database, Sept. 9, 1984 $b (environmental audit; environmental
       compliance auditing; environmental auditing)
```

E.3. Citing telephone calls and email correspondence

In order to use information obtained by telephone or over email to support a subject heading proposal, use one of the following citation forms: ***Phone call to [*name of person*]***; ***Email from [*name of person*]***. Include the date of the contact and also include, when pertinent and available, the person's title and the organization with which the person is affiliated. Provide in

parentheses a brief summary of the relevant information provided by the person in a $b subfield.

Example:

Heading proposed: Public history

670 ## $a Phone call to M. Cantelon, Natl. Council on Public History, Sept. 15, 2000 $b (term “public history” has not yet acquired a fixed meaning)

E.4. Citing the Old Catalog heading

When proposing a heading for a named entity, geographic feature, chemical, biological organism, etc., for which an Old Catalog heading exists and has been found, cite it by the phrase ***Old catalog heading*** followed by the heading in parentheses in a $b subfield.

Example:

Heading proposed: Marion Reservoir (Kan.)

670 ## $a Old catalog heading $b (Marion Lake, Kan.)

F. Citing sources in which the heading was not found

Use the 675 field to cite sources that were consulted but do not use the term or any variation of it. The same style as that used for citing sources that support the proposal may be used. No further data should be provided. The 675 field is not repeatable. Multiple sources appear in sequential $a subfields, separated by semicolons. Use no other subfield coding.

Example:

675 ## $a Soprintendenza per i beni archeologici della Puglia website, viewed Dec. 31, 2014; $a Princeton encyc. classic. Sites

Revision history

2026-03: Updated template. Corrected faulty metadata. Reorganized text and added examples.